Google Civic Information API: What You Can Build

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What it is today

The API now does two things: election data for a voter's address, and political district lookups. The "find my representatives" part is gone.

Google shut down both Representatives methods (`representativeInfoByAddress` and `representativeInfoByDivision`) on April 30, 2025. The Elections and Divisions APIs were not affected and are still supported. Many older tutorials and apps online are built on the retired endpoints, so don't build on them.

All calls are simple GETs against `https://www.googleapis.com/civicinfo/v2` with your API key.

The four endpoints

`/voterinfo` is the one that powers most voting apps; the other three support it.

Endpoint	Method name	What it does	Key parameters
`GET /voterinfo`	voterInfoQuery	Everything relevant to a voter at their registered address	`address` (required), `electionId`, `officialOnly`
`GET /elections`	electionQuery	Lists the elections currently available, with their IDs	none
`GET /divisionsByAddress`	divisionsByAddress	Every political district containing an address, with Open Civic Data IDs (OCD IDs) and names	`address`
`GET /divisions`	search	Finds divisions by natural name or OCD ID	`query`

The data you get back

One address into `/voterinfo` returns where to vote, what's on the ballot, and who runs the election.

Data group	Response field	What's in it	Why it matters
Where to vote	`pollingLocations`, `earlyVoteSites`, `dropOffLocations`	Address, hours, start and end dates, latitude and longitude, notes such as which accessibility entrance to use	Lat/long makes a map-based app easy
What's on the ballot	`contests`	Office, level of government (federal down to school board and special districts), district, seats, how many you can vote for, ballot order	Lets you rebuild a personal sample ballot
Candidates	`contests[].candidates`	Name, party, campaign website, phone, email, photo URL, ballot order, social channels	One-tap candidate research
Ballot measures	`contests[].referendum*`	Title, summary, full text, pro and con statements, passage threshold (e.g. two-thirds), effect of abstaining	The richest part of the API for an "understand your ballot" app
Who runs the election	`state[].electionAdministrationBody`, `local_jurisdiction`	Office names, addresses, hours, officials' contact info; links for registration, registration check, absentee voting, ballot info, election rules; emergency notice text and URL	The "who do I call" layer

Data group	Response field	What's in it	Why it matters
Mail-only flag	`mailOnly`	Whether the precinct votes only by mail	Changes what your app tells the voter to do

Every piece also carries a `sources` list with an `official` true/false flag, so your app can show whether data came straight from the government.

Apps you could build

The fastest strong launch is the polling-place finder plus an AI ballot-measure explainer in one app.

1. **"Where do I vote?" finder.** Address in, map out: polling place, nearest early voting sites, and drop boxes with hours and dates.
2. **Personalized sample ballot.** Exactly the races and measures on that voter's ballot, in ballot order.
3. **Ballot measure explainer.** Feed the referendum text plus pro and con statements to an LLM for plain-English summaries.
4. **Candidate research hub.** Every candidate on the ballot with links to their site and socials.
5. **Voting-plan and reminder app.** Early voting dates and site hours, a chosen plan, push reminders, and alerts from the emergency notice field.
6. **Election office directory.** The right local office contact plus registration and absentee links.
7. **District mapper.** `/divisionsByAddress` tells someone every district they live in: congressional, state house and senate, county, city council, school board. The OCD IDs are the join key for other datasets.
8. **Representatives via a partner.** Pair OCD IDs with another provider, such as BallotReady's Officeholders API, which covers over 300,000 officeholders down to city councils and school boards.

Gotchas to plan for

The biggest design constraint: election data vanishes after election day, so the app needs a good "no upcoming election" state.

Gotcha	What the rules say	What to build for it
Data expires	Elections auto-expire after election day; no data is returned after that	A graceful between-elections screen
Slow quota increases	Approval takes 1-2 months; Google recommends filing November requests by end of August	Expect default quota for the midterms next week
User-facing only	Extra quota is granted only for user-facing apps	No bulk scraping for analytics
Caching limits	Without cache headers: max 24 hours for voting locations and contests, 30 days for districts	Short cache TTLs
No experiments	No A/B tests, holdbacks, or similar; every user gets the same experience	Ship one experience
Same-day elections	Two elections on one day return no polling, contest, or official info until you re-query with an `electionId`	A "pick your election" step
Status codes	`noStreetSegmentFound`, `addressUnparseable`, `electionOver` and others; data may still come back with an error code	Handle each status explicitly

Gotcha	What the rules say	What to build for it
Last-minute changes	Officials revise data often in the final weeks and days	Tell users to check back before voting
Coverage	Set by the Voting Information Project's elections calendar	Check coverage before promising a state

Documentation and sources

- Civic Information API home
  https://developers.google.com/civic-information
- API reference (all endpoints)
  https://developers.google.com/civic-information/docs/v2
- voterInfoQuery: full field list
  https://developers.google.com/civic-information/docs/v2/elections/voterInfoQuery
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  https://developers.google.com/civic-information/docs/using_api
- VIP election coverage calendar
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- Notice of turndown of the Representatives API
  https://groups.google.com/g/google-civicinfo-api/c/9fwFn-dhktA/m/ftUoL83mAwAJ
- Support forum
  https://groups.google.com/g/google-civicinfo-api
- BallotReady Officeholders API
  https://organizations.ballotready.org/officeholders-api